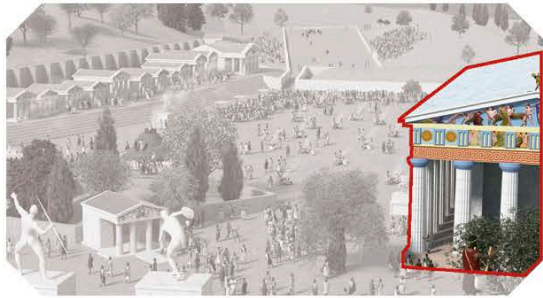


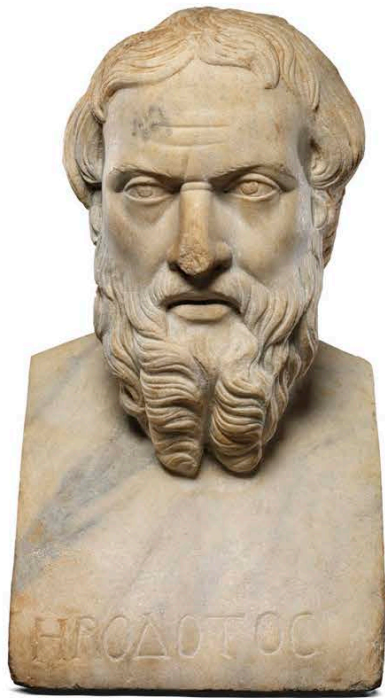
TEMPLE OF ZEUS

Finished in 463 BCE, this shrine to the king of the gods is an awe-inspiring building. Its white plaster gleams like marble and its colors are bright and freshly-painted. Inside, an enormous statue of Zeus presides over the temple. It has only been in place for four years, but it is already famous for its size and splendor. A stream of visitors make their way up the temple steps to see the statue and pay homage to almighty Zeus.



Six marble columns support the front of the temple.

Herodotus stands below the temple steps, reading extracts from his latest work to anyone who will listen.

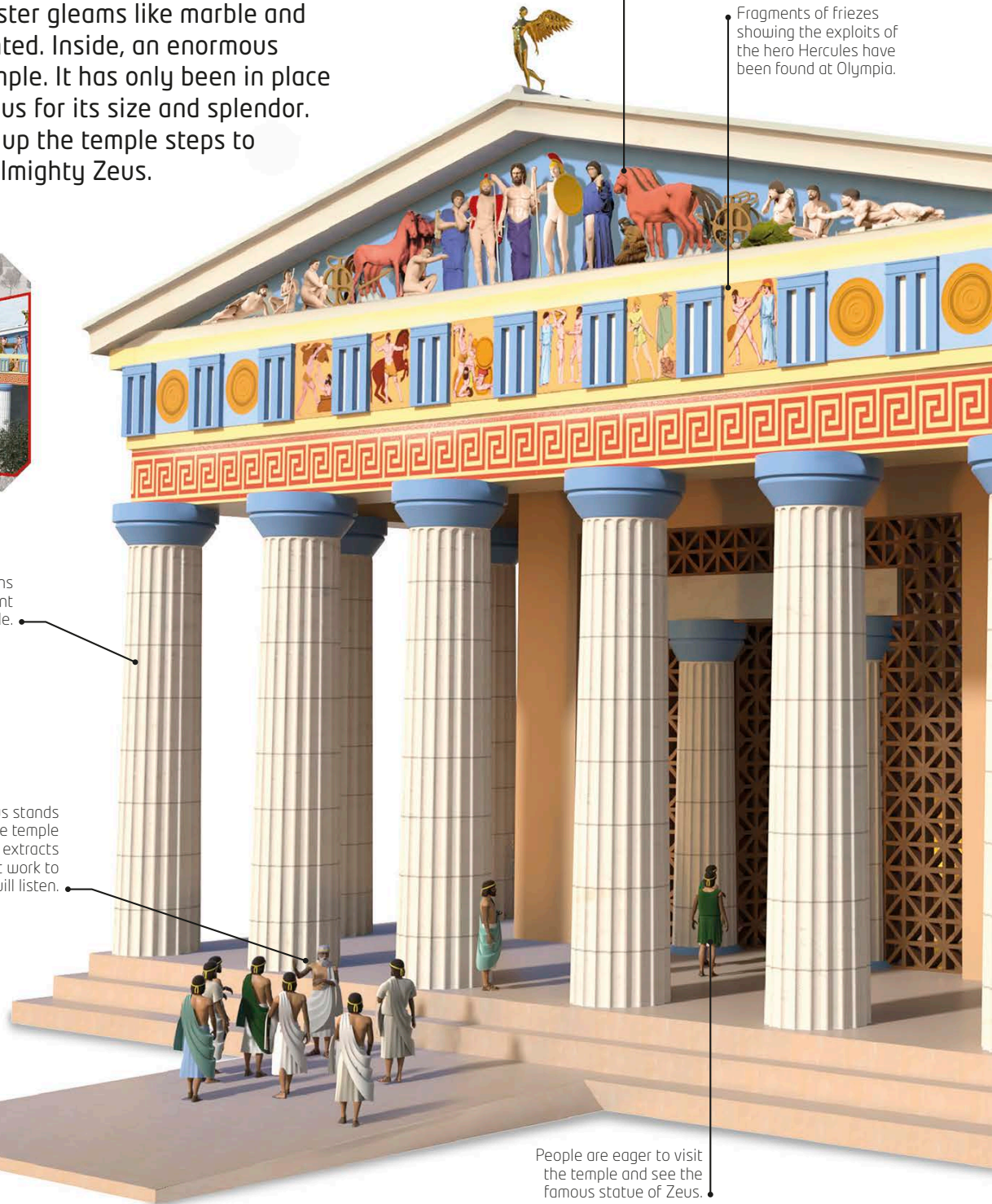


Herodotus

The writer and historian Herodotus went to the Olympics in 426 BCE. He stood on the east steps of the Temple of Zeus and read aloud from his *Histories*. Being heard at Olympia could make a writer famous.

The temple is beautifully decorated with bright, eye-catching colors.

Fragments of friezes showing the exploits of the hero Hercules have been found at Olympia.



People are eager to visit the temple and see the famous statue of Zeus.

"And immediately everyone knew him much **better** than the **Olympic victors** themselves. There was no one who had not heard of the name of **Herodotus**."

—Lucian of Samosata, writing in the 2nd century CE